

Northwind Energy Holding

Program: Microsoft Unified - Technical Status Review | Report date: 2026-09-11

Executive summary

On the evening of 19 August 2026 the authentication service was unavailable for roughly 3 hours and 40 minutes; the dealer portal and the field application were affected. The review, run from 25 August to 10 September, shows the cause was not a single fault but four structural gaps in resilience, privileged access and operational monitoring.

All four proposed actions can be delivered through proactive services already included in the current Unified agreement; none of them requires buying additional licences.

Findings

The identity infrastructure depends on a single region with no automatic failover to a second region. The architecture review recorded this as a high-severity finding; it is what directly extended the duration of the outage.

Multi-factor authentication is not enforced on 14 privileged accounts, and 6 of those hold a permanent administrator role. The access inventory recorded this as a high-severity finding.

Backups are taken regularly, but no restore drill has been carried out in the last 11 months. The actual recovery time is therefore unmeasured today; recorded as a medium-severity finding.

Monitoring alerts are generated but no one owns the follow-up. During the August outage the alert was raised at 20:12 and the team noticed at 21:05; mean time to detect was measured at 53 minutes.

Risks and opportunities

Risk: Taken together, the single-region dependency and the 53-minute detection time make it realistic that a similar identity outage recurs and again lasts for hours.

Risk: Permanent administrator roles and missing multi-factor authentication meet in the same accounts; if one privileged account is compromised, the impact spreads across the production environment.

Opportunity: Because every action fits inside the current agreement, concrete progress can be made during this year without waiting for the 2027 budget cycle.

Proposed actions

Proposed priority	Proposed action	Success criterion	Proposed owner and timing
P1	Remove permanent administrator roles from privileged accounts, move to a time-bound elevation model, and enforce multi-factor authentication on all privileged accounts.	Multi-factor authentication becomes mandatory on all 14 privileged accounts and the number of permanent administrator roles falls from 6 to zero.	Owner: Infrastructure management Timing: 0-30 days
P1	Address the second-region failover design for the identity infrastructure in a resilience workshop and produce the associated test plan.	An approved multi-region failover design and its test plan are delivered in writing.	Owner: Infrastructure management Timing: 0-60 days
P2	Define an owned operational follow-up routine and an incident escalation threshold for monitoring alerts.	Mean time to detect falls from 53 minutes to below 15 minutes and every critical alert has a named owner.	Owner: Infrastructure management Timing: 0-60 days
P2	Run the backup restore drill end to end in a separate maintenance window and record the measured recovery time.	The drill missing for 11 months is completed and the measured recovery time is documented in a findings report.	Owner: Infrastructure management Timing: 30-90 days

Verified relevant service matches

Service	Evidence-backed relevance
Identity Resilience Design Workshop	Maps directly to the single-region dependency finding. The catalogue defines it as a two-day workshop, delivered against proactive hours and requiring no additional licence.
Privileged Access Security Assessment	Covers permanent role identification, the transition plan to time-bound elevation and the multi-factor authentication roadmap; delivered against proactive hours with no additional licence.
Business Continuity Restore Drill	Covers the missing restore drill; delivered against proactive hours and requires a separate maintenance window to be scheduled.

References

Closeout meeting transcript — Session of 11 September 2026

Engineer field note — Findings table, items F1 to F4

Unified proactive service catalogue — Catalogue section 4.2

Unified proactive service catalogue — Catalogue section 6.1

Unified proactive service catalogue — Catalogue section 7.3